Haien Peng

Ph.D. Student in Economics | The University of Texas at Dallas

Haien.Peng@UTDallas.edu | haienpeng.github.io

Research Interests

Econometrics; Causal Inference

Education

The University of Texas at Dallas — Richardson, TX, USA
Ph.D. in Economics; Research Field: Econometrics — *Aug. 2023–Present*

University of Southampton — Southampton, United Kingdom
M.Sc. in Finance and Econometrics — *Sept. 2021–Sept. 2022*

Shanghai University — Shanghai, China
Bachelor of Management in Information Management and Information System — *Sept. 2015–July 2019*

Research Papers and Ongoing Projects

Robustly Combined Synthetic Control Estimation — *Working paper*
Develops a synthetic control approach based on donor sieving and combining multiple synthetic control estimates.

Research Experience

Research Assistant, The University of Texas at Dallas — Richardson, TX, USA
Supervisor: Prof. Timothy M. Bray — *Aug. 2024–Aug. 2025*

- Developed code to extract and organize crime records from PDF documents into structured Excel datasets for research use.
- Contributed to the preparation of written narratives for *Beyond ABC: Assessing the Well-Being of Children in North Texas*.

Quantitative Methods in the Chinese Stock Market — Southampton, UK
Research project; Supervisor: Prof. Jose Olmo — *July 2022–Sept. 2022*

- Compared the predictive performance of quantitative methods with linear and autoregressive models using lagged returns in China's A-share market.
- Evaluated prediction accuracy and changes in R^2 relative to the benchmark models.

Improvement and Application of Mean-Variance Models — Southampton, UK
Research project; Supervisor: Prof. Jose Olmo — *June 2022–Sept. 2022*

- Examined Bayesian modifications to mean-variance and minimum-variance portfolio optimization and compared them with conventional strategies.
- Evaluated five asset-allocation methods on the SSE 50 Index using rolling windows and different risk-aversion parameters.

Teaching Experience

Instructor, ECON 4355: Econometrics — UT Dallas
Undergraduate course — *Aug. 2026–Present*

Instructor, Economics Ph.D. Math Camp — UT Dallas
Mathematics instruction for incoming Ph.D. students — *Aug. 2026*

Teaching Assistant — UT Dallas
ECON 6309: Econometrics I;
ECON 4382: International Finance;
ECON 5322: Macroeconomic Theory for Applications — *Jan. 2026–May 2026*

Teaching Assistant — UT Dallas
ECON 3311: Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory — *Aug. 2025–Dec. 2025*

Professional Experience

Guangzhou Wanyun Information Technology Co., Ltd. Guangzhou, China
Finance Intern *Aug. 2019–Oct. 2019*

- Prepared and maintained accounting records, assisted with financial reconciliation and statements, and supported payroll and tax-related accounting tasks.

Zhongbiao Network Technology Co., Ltd. Shanghai, China
Intern *June 2018–July 2018*

- Configured web-crawling tools and supported data ingestion, formatting, and quality checks.

Honors and Awards

- Excellent Graduation Design (Thesis) Award, *Recommendation Algorithm Based on User-Based Implicit Factors*, 2019.
- Honorable Mention, Interdisciplinary Contest in Modeling, *Regional Instability: Multiple Criteria Decision Making Model Focus on Climate Change*, 2018.

Technical Skills

R; Stata; Python; MATLAB